



Social Media and Politics in Tamil Nadu

Algorithmic Amplification and Public Engagement

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Why This Study

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- Regional political impact is not well studied
- Tamil Nadu is very active on social media

What We Want to Study

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1. Types of political content
2. How people react to this content
3. How algorithms increase visibility
4. What this means for elections

Data Used

- Instagram political posts

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- Instagram political posts
- YouTube political videos

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- YouTube political videos
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- Collected over three months

Types of Political Content

- Official political messages

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- Speech clips

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- Emotional content

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Types of Political Content

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- Speech clips
- Emotional content
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- News and commentary

How We Measure Engagement

Instagram

$$\frac{\text{Likes} + \text{Comments}}{\text{Followers}}$$

YouTube

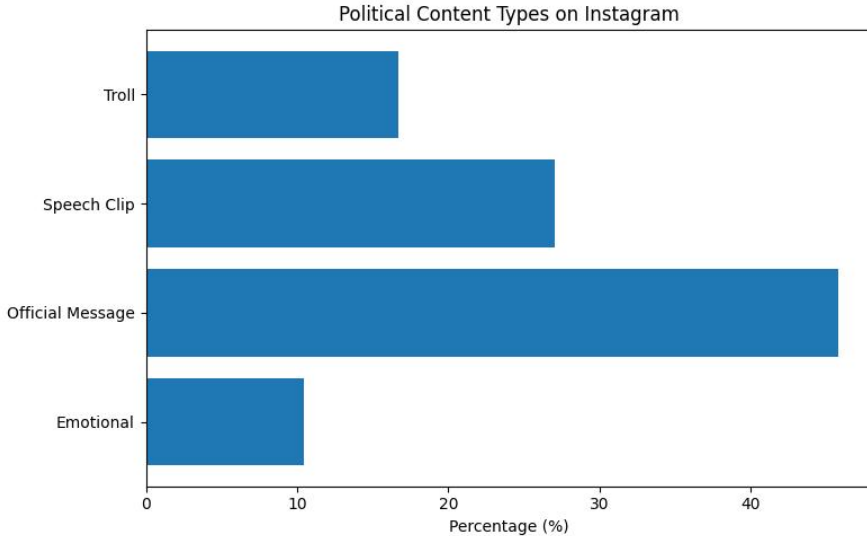
$$\frac{\text{Comments}}{\text{Views}}$$

Algorithmic Amplification

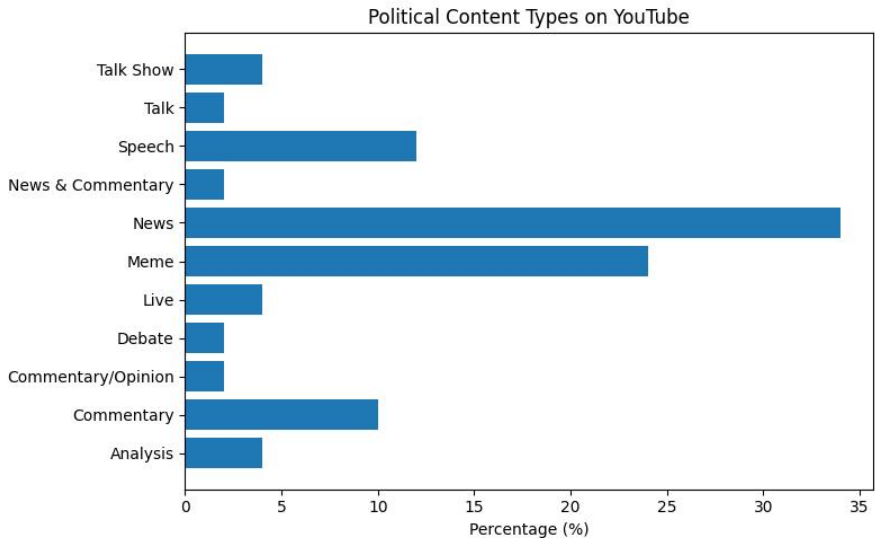
$$\frac{\text{Content Engagement}}{\text{Platform Average Engagement}}$$

- Greater than 1 means more visibility
- Less than 1 means less visibility

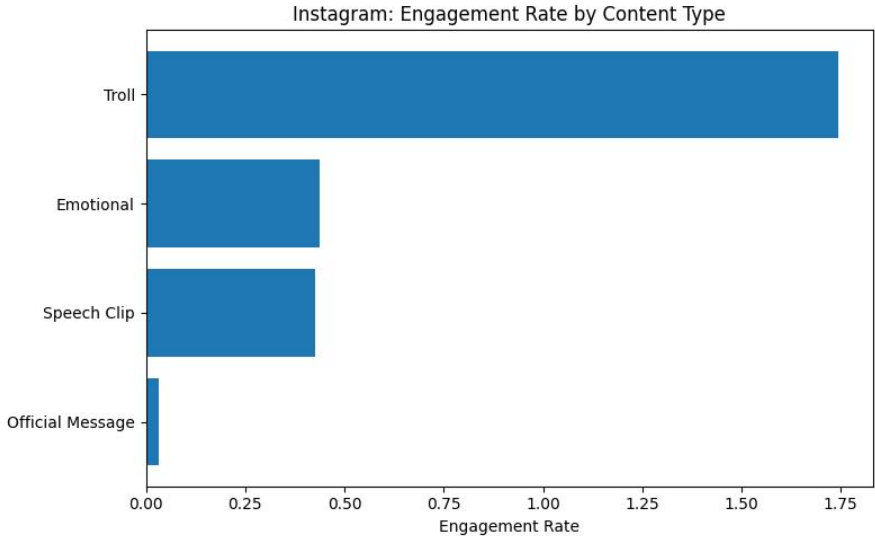
Instagram: Content Types



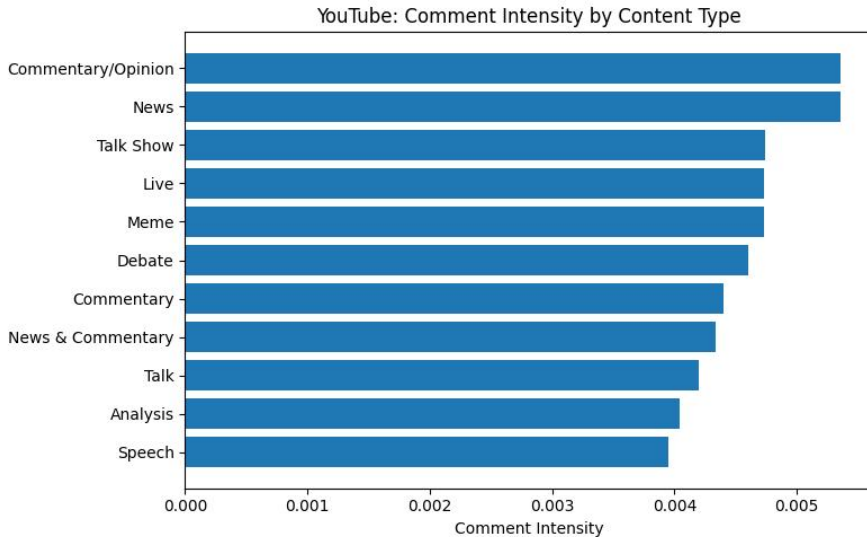
YouTube: Content Types



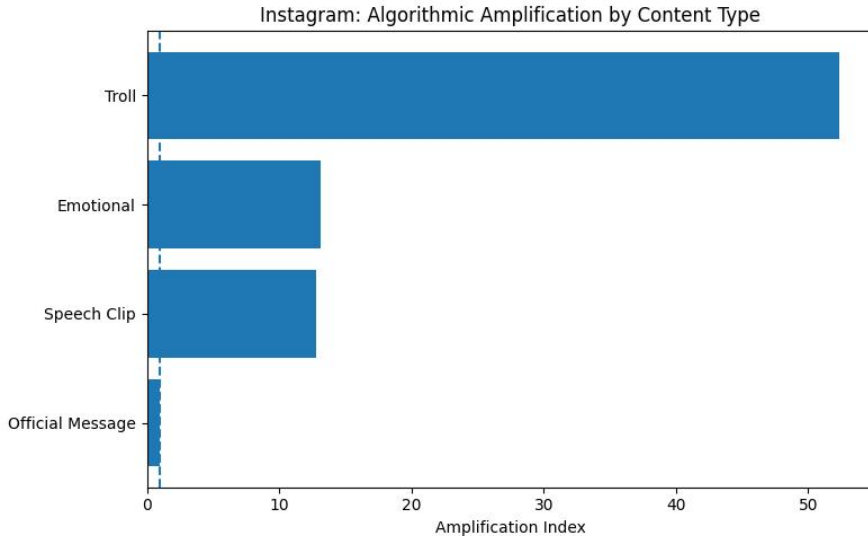
Instagram: Engagement



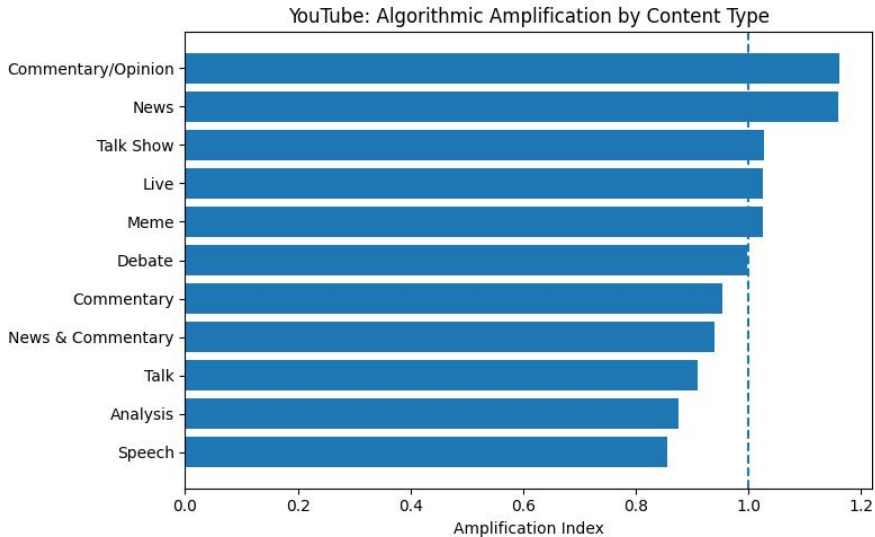
YouTube: Engagement



Instagram: Amplification



YouTube: Amplification



Main Findings

- Emotional and troll content spreads faster

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- Official messages get less attention
- Algorithms reward engagement, not importance

What This Means for Elections

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- Visibility affects public discussion
- Possible indirect impact on voters

Limitations

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- Voting behavior is not measured

**Social media algorithms
are not neutral**

Thank You

Questions?